

L1.9 In-class Assignment – Special Values and Factors

CPSC 292 – 9/14/2026

Name: _____ **Section:** _____

Collaboration team: _____

Question 1

What makes factors a useful data class for statistical analyses?

Question 2

Create a vector of 10 character-class days of the week. Convert this vector into an ordered factor with 7 levels, each level being a day of the week, in the order in which each day occurs.

Question 3

How can you check a vector for NA values? What about NaN or Inf values?

Question 4

▼ penguins	344 obs. of 8 variables	
\$ species	: Factor w/ 3 levels "Ade..."	
\$ island	: Factor w/ 3 levels "Bis..."	
\$ bill_len	: num 39.1 39.5 40.3 NA ...	
\$ bill_dep	: num 18.7 17.4 18 NA 19...	
\$ flipper_len	: int 181 186 195 NA 193...	
\$ body_mass	: int 3750 3800 3250 NA ...	
\$ sex	: Factor w/ 2 levels "fem..."	
\$ year	: int 2007 2007 2007 200...	

Figure 1: The penguins data set

Using the `penguins` data set, perform the following coercions which replace the original columns:

- The `sex` column to character class.
- The `body_mass` column to numeric class.
- The `year` column into an ordered factor.

Question 5

Describe three of the “as dot” functions and how they work.